

Americas Chemicals: Recent Chinese TiO₂ Export Data Remains Elevated; Updating KRO Estimates

Chinese April TiO₂ net export data released indicates sustained high export volumes to markets where Western producers (CC, TROX, KRO) compete. Year-to-date through April TiO₂ net exports are up 88kt (a 14% increase). We have long viewed China's net export number, the key metric by which to judge the health of Western TiO₂ producers markets. The higher exports were surprising to us given the sulfur issues but that extra volume will likely lead to weaker than expected price increases in 2H. The Indian anti-dumping duty (ADD) remains suspended, with no definitive timeline for a judicial decision regarding its potential reinstatement; however since China lacks bonded warehouses in India, any reinstatement would likely have an immediate market impact. In April, Chinese exports to India increased by 14kt to 32kt, contributing to a year-to-date increase of 32kt, or 28%. Similarly, April exports to the EU increased by 4kt to 20kt, with year-to-date volumes up 19kt, a 32% increase. It seems the impact of elevated sulfur on Chinese production has not done enough to curtail exports into the international market, indicating that the Chinese product is more resilient than expected. Regarding demand, paint volumes (the dominant end market for TiO₂) looks weaker than we expected to start the year. With meaningfully higher Chinese exports and paint volumes weaker than expected, we believe the TiO₂ market will soften by the end of the summer and that could lead to pricing move up less than expected.

Duffy Fischer

+1(212)902-0099 |
duffy.fischer@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Ramsey Abdulrahim

+1(212)902-0091 |
ramsey.abdulrahim@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

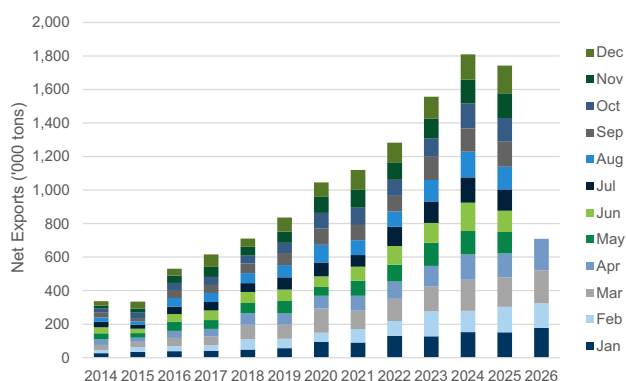
Mike Harris

+1(212)902-3667 | mike.harris@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Jordan Lee

+1(212)357-6986 | jordan.lee@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

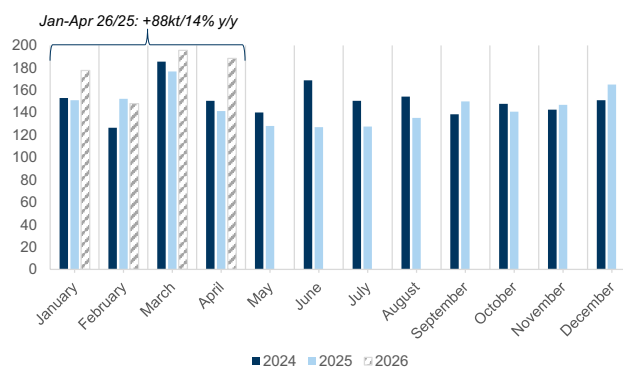
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Exhibit 1: Chinese Net Exports

Source: China Government Export Data

Exhibit 2: Chinese Net TiO2 Exports

MoM, in kt



Source: China Government Export Data

Exhibit 3: China TiO2 Exports to the EU

EU	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	YTD
2023	21	25	21	20	31	24	23	17	19	14	16	24	256
2024	32	29	32	34	24	17	7	18	11	17	10	12	243
2025	12	14	17	16	15	16	11	11	11	15	14	16	169
2026	16	19	24	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	79

Source: China Government Export Data

Exhibit 4: China TiO2 Exports to India

India	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	YTD
2023	20	28	24	19	19	15	19	21	20	17	21	25	248
2024	22	17	26	22	23	35	27	30	23	23	30	29	308
2025	30	33	34	18	10	13	17	15	23	17	18	29	257
2026	49	29	39	32	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	149

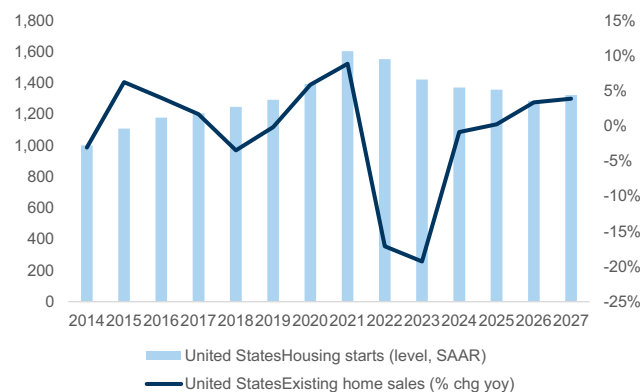
Source: China Government Export Data

We update our estimates to reflect the positive impact KRO is seeing from the lower operating rates they ran in late 2025. Their Q4 loss underlines the high fixed cost absorption that ran through the P&L. In 1H26, they are seeing the benefit of making that operating decision last year. KRO is also seeing a benefit from the structural cost actions they took plus some price and some improvement in ore costs. We think that later into the year, KRO production rates could catch up with sales volumes which they have been under since 2Q25. Separately, we introduce 2028 forecasts.

Exhibit 5: GS EBITDA Revisions

EBITDA Estimates (adj)			
Period	New	Old	% Change
2Q26	36	19	86%
3Q26	44	30	50%
FY2026	136	82	66%
FY2027	154	157	-2%
FY2028	167	-	-

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: Existing Home Sales Remain Subdued
in thousands

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: US New home sales (level, SAAR)

in thousands



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and Key Risks:

We are Sell rated on KRO with a 12-month price target of \$7 (from \$5 prior), which is based on a 9.0x EV/EBITDA on our 2027 estimates (from 14x 2026 EBITDA prior). The change in our target multiple is due to roll forward of the multiple year.

We see four upside risks as it relates to our rating on KRO: 1) Demand could strengthen into the TiO₂ industry's supply side reduction moves driving supply-demand to tighten meaningfully leading to unexpected price increases. 2) The cost of upstream titanium ore could weaken meaningfully, helping Kronos and negatively impacting more integrated peers. Kronos is much more exposed to titanium ore purchased from large miners/refiners. 3) The ownership structure could change which may bring more attention, more float and new investors into the stock. With only ~20% float, KRO may not appear on the screens of large funds.

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Contributing Authors: Duffy Fischer Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Ramsey Abdulrahim Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Mike Harris Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Jordan Lee Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC.

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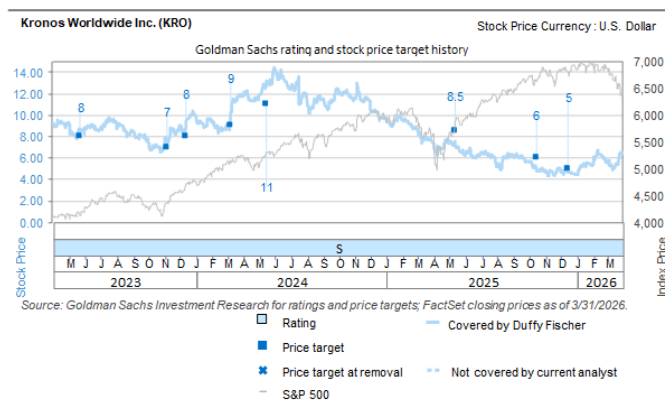
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Kronos Worldwide Inc. (KRO)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
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16-Oct-25	6.00	5.00
14-May-25	8.50	7.17
15-May-24	11.00	12.70
08-Mar-24	9.00	10.34
14-Dec-23	8.00	9.50
07-Nov-23	7.00	7.36

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